Hui-Jhong (Hugh) Choi

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Education

Simon Business School, University of Rochester
PhD Student in Finance — *2023 – Present*
MS in Business Research — *2026*

Korea University
MA in Economics — *2023*
BA in Economics, Minor in Mathematics — *2020*

Research Interests

Asset Pricing, Investor Beliefs and Disagreement

Working Papers

"Model Disagreement and Factor Momentum"

I study whether disagreement about which characteristics are priced explains factor momentum. In a model where investors hold dogmatic and differing views about the characteristic through which a common factor affects payoffs, equilibrium prices underreact to the true factor loading. Greater disagreement then raises factor return autocorrelation, factor volatility, and time series factor momentum up to a threshold. I construct two novel measures of model disagreement for 152 characteristics, one from I/B/E/S analyst price targets and one from 13F institutional holdings. Both measures are positively related to all three model quantities in Fama–MacBeth predictive regressions. Disagreement predicts both the short-term and the longer-term timing component of factor momentum. Taken together, the results imply that disagreement may drive factor momentum.

Work in Progress

"The Term Structure of Corporate Required Rates" with Qixiang Gao

This paper proposes a systematic approach, combining recent advances in characteristics-based asset pricing with dimensionality-reduction techniques, to estimate the term structure of required equity returns for U.S. stocks. The estimated premium sensitivities to firm characteristics change substantially with the investment horizon, indicating that the composition of priced risk shifts as the holding period lengthens. In an application to corporate investment, we find that longer-horizon required rates are more strongly associated with firm-level investment than short-horizon premia, and that firms with longer asset maturity are especially sensitive to these long-term required rates, consistent with the idea that their investments face longer cash-flow duration.

Publications

"Finding Inflation Uncertainty Factors: A Sparse Stochastic Volatility Approach" with Kyu Ho Kang, July 2025, *Journal of Financial Econometrics*, 23(4).

Teaching Experience

Instructor

2026 Fall A	Foundations in Financial Economics–Lab (MSF), Lab Instructor
2026 Spring A	Quantitative Investing–Lab (MSF), Lab Instructor (Rating: 4.7/5)

Teaching Assistant

* denotes courses for which duties included regular recitation sections.

2024 Fall B, 2025 Fall B	Financial Markets and Investment (MSF), TA for Prof. Robert Novy-Marx
2025 Fall A	Foundations of Financial Economics (MSF), TA for Prof. Alexandr Kopytov
2025 Spring B	Quantitative Finance with Python (MSF), TA for Prof. Alan Moreira
2024 Fall A	Corporate Finance (MSF), TA for Prof. Christian Opp
2020 Fall	Statistics for Economists (Undergraduate), TA* for Prof. Dukpa Kim

Honors, Fellowships & Research Grants

2023 – 2028	Rochester Simon PhD Fellowship
2022	Research Challenger Program Research Grant, Korea University
2021	Outstanding Research Proposal Award, Korea University
2021 – 2022	BK21+ Fellowship, National Research Foundation of Korea
2020 – 2021	Korea University Incoming Graduate Merit Scholarship

Industry Experience & Service

JP Morgan Chase & Co. *Jun – Sep 2019*
Credit Risk Specialist (Internship) *Seoul, Korea*

CGS-CIMB Securities *Sep 2018 – Feb 2019*
Equity Research Intern *Seoul, Korea*

Aerospace Medical Center, ROK Air Force *Jul 2015 – Jul 2017*
Sergeant (Mandatory Military Service) *Cheongju, Korea*

Other Affiliations

Investment & Finance Research Association (IFRA)
Member, 23rd Cohort; Vice President, 25th Cohort *Seoul, Korea*

Languages

Korean (native), English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (conversational)

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